Phase 1 Marketing

1. Before anyone new arrives (this week)

- ☐ Lock the final name and handles, because renaming after creator posts wastes them.
- ☐ Turn on the global spend cap and billing alerts.
- ☐ Make sure you can track the path from install to generated recipe, cooked photo and share, with tagged links so you know which post drove which install.
- ☐ Seed the feed with 50–100 real cooked photos so it doesn't look empty.
- ☐ Make sure someone is actually handling moderation and reports. Apple expects this for apps with user content.
- ☐ Get the post-for-reward feature checked. If it's uncertain, launch without it and add it later, because ads can still earn the extra slots.

2. Small changes worth making first

- ☐ Put the AI concept image next to the real photo in the share clip, if it's still left out.
- ☐ Add a one-tap share that doesn't require cooking.
- ☐ Let people vote from a shared link without an account.

Group mode can wait.

3. Quiet release (2–3 weeks, 100–300 people)

Use friends, students and small communities. Look for the biggest drop-off and fix that first.

The step to watch is **generating a recipe → actually cooking it**, because the whole concept depends on it. If people generate but rarely cook, try a smaller "cook this tonight" dare or a lower-effort proof before spending on reach.

4. Start posting now

The video series from the plan still applies, but now it can show the real app and link to it.

Thanksgiving "leftover crimes" on Nov 26 is your first campaign, and Christmas leftovers can be the second. If app review isn't finished by then, post anyway and send people to a waitlist.

5. Creators once the flow works

Rework the list first, then contact 15–20 at a time. They can now try the real app, which makes the pitch much stronger:

> *"Cook a Crime Level 80 dish from your own fridge, then let your comments rule."*

6. Save the big push

April Fools' 2027 still works as your press moment, but as a second wave rather than your first day. Paid installs still don't make sense until you can see ad revenue per user.